

SABINA SOCOLI

Junior Security Developer & QA Engineer · Python · Go · ISC2 CC Candidate · Ships Real Products

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Chişinău, Moldova · Open to relocation – EU

PROFILE

Career-pivoter with a decade of cross-sector experience in consulting, project management, and digital strategy, making a deliberate and committed pivot to cybersecurity and software quality engineering. In 2024–2025, completed three coding programmes, built and shipped multiple security and productivity tools in Python and Go, and began active preparation for the ISC2 Certified in Cybersecurity (CC) examination (November 2026). Brings meticulous attention to detail, multilingual communication across four languages, hands-on experience managing technical teams and developer workflows, and a published novel — the same sustained attention to detail that finds the bug nobody else caught.

TRAINING & CERTIFICATIONS

- ISC2 Certified in Cybersecurity (CC)** · ISC2 2026 (pending)
- Exam scheduled November 2026 · In active preparation · OWASP Top 10, access control, incident response, GDPR compliance
- Code First Girls CFGdegree Assessment** · Code First Girls 2026
- Passed technical screening for CFGdegree programme · Python, APIs, data structures, file handling, HTTP methods
- Software Development Processes and Methodologies** · University of Minnesota · Coursera Oct 2022
- SDLC, Agile, Scrum, Waterfall, software quality
- Go Lang Foundations** · 01Founders Sep 2024
- Intensive gamified programme · Final project: Sudoku solver in Go
- Python & API Integration — 🏆 Cohort-Wide First Place** · Code First Girls Aug–Sep 2024
- Built and deployed a live production web application · Only team in cohort to ship to production
- BBA in Marketing — Cum Laude** · Central Pacific University, Sharjah, UAE 2004

PRACTICAL PROJECTS

- Password Strength Tester · Go** · Personal Security Project 2026
- Built a CLI security tool in Go that analyses password strength against multiple criteria: length, character type diversity, and a blacklist of commonly used passwords.
 - Implemented case-insensitive substring matching to catch variations of blacklisted words (e.g. Dragon444# alongside dragon).
 - Designed user-facing feedback with specific remediation guidance for each failure condition — applying QA reporting principles to security tooling.
 - Stack: Go · WSL/Ubuntu · Git · GitHub
- Words of Kindness · Python Desktop App** · Personal Project 2024
- Built and shipped a standalone Windows desktop application using Python and tkinter that delivers randomised affirmations via a GUI button interface.
 - Packaged as a distributable .exe for non-technical end users — demonstrating end-to-end ownership from code to deployment.
 - Stack: Python · tkinter · random module · PyInstaller

Fridge-to-Dinner Web Application · Code First Girls — 🏆 First Place · Group Project 2024

- Built and deployed to Render a Python/Flask web app that accepts ingredient input, calls an external REST API, and returns five personalised dinner suggestions — the only team in the cohort to ship a live production product.
- Stack: Python · Flask · REST API · JavaScript · HTML/CSS · GitHub · Render
- Deployment-first mindset: insisted on real production hosting, demonstrating early QA instinct — software must be verified in the environment where it will actually run.

Sudoku Solver in Go · 01Founders · Final Project Sep 2024

- Designed and implemented a working Sudoku puzzle generator and solver as the final project for an intensive Go Lang programme.
- Deepened understanding of compiled, statically-typed languages — directly relevant to cross-platform QA testing.

AngelHack Hackathon — NHS AI Triage App · AngelHack / HabberTec Jun 2016

- Project Manager in a cross-functional team of doctors and developers; built a Spanish-language triaging service for the NHS powered by IBM Watson API within a single hackathon sprint.
- Coordinated rapid prototyping under time pressure — precursor to the Agile/sprint methodology now central to QA and software delivery teams.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Social Media Manager · Consumer Attorneys Law Firm Jun 2025 – Present

- Architected and executed a flywheel content strategy across six platforms, producing 80+ pieces of content monthly with consistent strategic coherence.
- Designed 18 multi-platform campaigns; generated 29K+ TikTok views through targeted short-form strategy.
- Produced monthly performance reports tracking reach, engagement, and views — building comfort with data-driven iterative improvement, a core QA discipline.

Consultant / Project Manager · Project Iris Consulting Apr 2019 – Mar 2020

- Led tech delivery projects in Sprints using Agile methodology, coordinating UX designers, developers, marketing, and legal — managing JIRA-style developer tickets initiated on GitHub.
- Worked individually with each developer to define deliverables and validate output against requirements — an early form of acceptance testing.
- Designed user journey flows and conducted user research interviews to produce informed personas.

Startups Consultant / PM · SearchSmartly · CodeYourFuture · LGBT Foundation Apr 2017 – Mar 2020

- Collaborated with a Python developer to validate and process 30,000 data points, retaining 96% of business partners — applied QA thinking to real data quality at scale.
- Led full website migration from Drupal to WordPress: content audit, restructuring, and UAT-style review of the live site before sign-off.
- Implemented GDPR data-handling policies and optimised user journeys through structured user interviews.

Business Development Manager · HabberTec (IBM Business Partner) Jun 2015 – Jun 2016

- Operated daily in IBM enterprise systems and CRM platforms; coordinated technical marketing campaigns for IBM Business Process Management software.
- Delivered webinars and led a team in a hackathon to build an AI-powered NHS triage app using IBM Watson API.

Founder · Ekliss.com — Fairtrade Fashion Brand

Jan 2012 – Jun 2014

- Founded a fairtrade scarf brand; built e-commerce site on PrestaShop with SEO strategy, B2C sales management, and Amazon affiliate integration.

Founder · Expressa-te.com — English Teaching School

Sep 2011 – Jun 2014

- Founded and scaled an English language school with 15 freelance teachers; ranked page one of Google organic search for 'profesor de inglés' through SEO, Google Ads, and PPC strategy.

Account Executive · Right Track Advertising

Mar 2005 – Mar 2006

- Managed accounts for consumer electronics launches, magazine campaigns, and a Western Union membership card rollout across all seven Emirates.

TECHNICAL SKILLS & LANGUAGES

Languages	Python · Go Lang · HTML · CSS · JavaScript (foundational)
QA & Dev	GitHub · REST API testing · Flask · Render · JIRA · Agile/Scrum · Debugging · Version Control · gofmt · WSL/Ubuntu
Security	ISC2 CC in preparation · OWASP Top 10 · GDPR compliance · Access control · Incident response · Password security analysis · Blacklist detection · Input sanitisation
Platforms	SocialBee · Planable · WordPress · Shopify · PrestaShop · Windows · Linux/WSL · IBM Watson
Spoken	Romanian (native) · English (near-native) · Spanish (fluent) · French (basic)

ADDITIONAL

Published author — Karma the Assassin, Book One (historical fiction, launched at Hale End Library, London; available in Waltham Forest Libraries). Completing a full-length novel requires the same qualities that define a strong QA engineer or security analyst: sustained concentration, systematic thinking, meticulous attention to detail, and the discipline to see a complex long-form project through to a finished, publishable result.